

INTEROFFICE COMMUNICATION
San Mateo Police Department
Support Services Division

DATE: July 7, 2021

TO: Captain David Peruzzaro

FROM: Lieutenant Todd Mefford

RE: Summary of Quarterly Audit of SMPD 'End-User' ALPR Data for Q2, 2021

Introduction

Per SMPD Standard Operating Procedure 205, our Department conducts quarterly audits of our 'End-User' data to ensure our employees are reviewing data in a manner consistent with policy and procedure. The data reviewed is generated and provided by the Northern California Regional Intelligence Center (NCRIC) and the Flock Platform Portal as they house data for the respective platforms. The results of these audits are summarized and presented to the Support Services Captain for review and later for retention by the Support Services Division.

Quarter 1, 2021

PIPs / BOSS (January, February, March)

Our employees conducted 43 searches of ALPR historical data through the NCRIC platform, which is almost a 300% decrease in quarterly usage. This increase is due to the new Flock ALPR Platform coming online. A number of searches were conducted as tests to check that the system was functioning correctly. 95% of all searches were determined to list the required criteria as required by our policy and procedure. A review with the end-user found that the three searches were appropriate under our Department policy and procedure. As is usual, the top two reasons for searches were "Stolen or Wanted" or "Criminal or Arrest."

Audit Focus	Q1/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	43	102
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	93	99.5%
Case numbers listed	27	83
Non-case numbers listed	15	19
(Reasons for search)		
Missing/Amber/Silver Alert	0	1.5
Criminal or Arrest	14	54
Special Event	2	0.17
Stolen or Wanted	27	39
Violent Crime	5	7

Quarter 1, 2021

Flock Safety (January, February, March)

The Flock ALPR platform went online for all officers to use in mid-February. Because this is a new platform, a large portion of the searches were test or blank “reason” searches in order to ensure correct functionality with the hardware (cameras) and software. The test or blank searches were conducted by primarily two employees. “Reason” for search, as contained in the above chart is not included in this chart because the Flock and NCRIC platforms report data differently. When employees request a search for historical data through the NCRIC portal, they are required to select one of the reasons provided in the dropdown menu. Flock does not have that feature and Reason is entered manually.

Training has been completed and there was a dramatic improvement on required data entered on the Flock platform. A memo adjusting procedure and emphasizing required criteria was shared with all end users. I anticipate this trend will continue with consistent monitoring and reinforcement. Quarterly Average is not available because this is the first quarter the Flock platform is being used.

Audit Focus	Q1/2021	Quarterly Average
Number of searches	3069	
Number of searches with required criteria (as %)	97%	
Case numbers listed	2109	
Non-case numbers listed	960	

Analysis and Conclusion

Our Department ‘End-User’ activity during the time period was consistent with Department policy and procedure. Our staff used this technology platform above normal usage rates, which is reasonable given the types of investigations they were conducting. No additional efforts are recommended.